

Reconstruction Era:

Goals - Reconstruction's aim was to bring the South back into the Union while protecting the rights and safety of the newly freed slaves. At the end of the Civil War, there were nearly 4 million former slaves in the South. It was the hope of Reconstructionists that they could be integrated into the fabric of a free society. Unfortunately, Reconstruction would fall short of its goal.

Amendments - 13th Amendment: While the Emancipation Proclamation ended slavery in the Confederacy, the Thirteenth Amendment abolished slavery in the entirety of the United States. It also granted Congress the right to enforce this with appropriate legislation should states defy the ordinance.

14th Amendment: This amendment ensured the Bill of Rights applied to all citizens of the United States of America, regardless of race. After Congress passed the Civil Rights Act of 1866, they realized they needed a firmer legal precedent to enforce the due process of law, equal protection of the laws, and so on within states. The Fourteenth Amendment allowed the federal government to challenge state governments when they abridged the immunities and rights of citizens on the basis of race. It effectively overturned the Supreme Court's Dred Scott decision by declaring everyone born on United States soil (including Black men and former enslaved people) citizens endowed with all the entailed rights.

15th Amendment: Black men could not vote in all states until Congress passed and ratified the Fifteenth Amendment. The stipulation secured voting rights for Black men, making it illegal to refuse them the right to vote on account of race or previous condition of servitude. Individual states in the former Confederacy tested the limits of congressional power on this front.

Politics - Central to Reconstruction was the effort of former slaves to breathe full meaning into their newly acquired freedom, and to claim their rights as citizens. Rather than passive victims of the actions of others, African Americans were active agents in shaping Reconstruction. After rejecting the Reconstruction plan of President Andrew Johnson, the Republican Congress enacted laws and Constitutional amendments that empowered the federal government to enforce the principle of equal rights, and gave black Southerners the right to vote and hold office. The new Southern governments confronted violent opposition from the Ku Klux Klan and similar groups. In time, the North abandoned its commitment to protect the rights of the former slaves, Reconstruction came to an end, and white supremacy was restored throughout the South.

Adversity - Columbia University's now-infamous Dunning School (1900-1930) epitomizes the dominant narrative regarding Reconstruction for over half of the twentieth century. From their point of view, Reconstruction was a tragic period of American history in which vengeful White Northern radicals took over the South. In order to punish the White Southerners they had just defeated in the Civil War, these Radical Republicans gave ignorant freedmen the right to vote. This resulted in at least 2,000 elected Black officeholders, including two United States senators and 21 representatives. In order to discredit the sweeping changes taking place across the American South, conservative historians argued this period was full of corruption and disorder and proved that Black Americans were not fit to leadership or citizenship.

Industrialization:

Technology - Technological innovations, including the telegraph, telephone, and electricity, revolutionized production processes and communication, driving economic growth. Railroad Expansion: The construction of the transcontinental railroad networks facilitated the movement of goods and people, connecting the country and promoting economic development. Notable technological advancements of the era. ■ - Thomas Edison's contributions, including the light bulb and phonograph. ■ - Expansion of telegraph and telephone networks. ■ - Significance of the transcontinental railroad.

Second Industrialization - a period of rapid growth in the U.S. manufacturing in the late 1800s.

Labor - Labor Force Expansion: The demand for labor in factories and industries led to mass migration from rural areas to urban centers, providing a growing workforce for industrial production. Challenges faced by industrial workers. ■ - Long hours, low wages, and dangerous workplaces. ■ - Emergence of labor unions and advocacy for workers' rights. ■ - Strikes and labor conflicts. ■ - Wealth disparity between the upper class and workers. ■ - Opulent lifestyles of the rich contrasted with working-class struggles. ■ - Social tensions and class conflicts.

Capitalism - An economic and political system in which a country's trade and industry are controlled by private owners for profit, rather than by the state.

Captain of Industry/Robber Barons - Some people saw them as Captains of Industry because they were inventive, hardworking and led the way in the rise of American business. Others saw them as Robber Barons because they were ruthless and self-centered entrepreneurs whose aggressive business practices destroyed the smaller competitors and drove many companies out of business.

Urbanization - Massive Migration: Industrialization during the Gilded Age led to a massive influx of people from rural areas to urban centers. As industries boomed and job opportunities in factories and mills increased, individuals and families left their rural homes in search of better employment prospects in the cities. ■ Urbanization: This migration wave fueled the rapid growth of major American cities. Urban centers like New York, Chicago, and Philadelphia saw their populations swell as rural residents flocked to these metropolitan areas. The development of factories, manufacturing plants, and other industrial facilities in cities attracted workers in large numbers.

Social Issues - Civil Rights and Jim Crow Laws: Racial tensions persisted, particularly in the South, where the Jim Crow system of segregation and discrimination against African Americans was enforced. Debates over civil rights and equality for Black Americans laid the groundwork for the civil rights movement in the 20th century. ■ Electoral Reforms: Calls for electoral reforms, including the direct election of senators (prior to the 17th Amendment) and campaign finance reform, were part of the political discourse. These reforms aimed to make the political system more accountable and transparent. ■ Foreign Policy: The United States grappled with foreign policy issues, including imperialism and expansionism. Debates centered on whether the U.S. should pursue overseas territories and engage in international conflicts, such as the Spanish-American War. ■ Immigration and Nativism: The influx of immigrants from Europe and Asia led to debates about immigration policy and nativism. Nativist groups, such as the Know-Nothings, advocated for restrictions on immigration and expressed anti-immigrant sentiments.

Economic Issues - Monopolies and Trusts: One of the most prominent debates centered on the rise of monopolies and trusts, such as Standard Oil and U.S. Steel. ■ There was a

growing concern about the unchecked power of these large corporations and whether they should be regulated or broken up to ensure fair competition. ■ **Interstate Commerce Act (1887)**: This landmark legislation established the Interstate Commerce Commission (ICC) and was one of the first attempts to regulate businesses engaged in interstate commerce, particularly railroads. It aimed to prevent discrimination and ensure fair rates. ■ **Sherman Antitrust Act (1890)**: This act was designed to curb the power of large monopolistic corporations by prohibiting anti competitive practices and promoting fair competition. It was the first federal legislation aimed at regulating trusts and monopolies. **Progressives - Labor Reforms**: (child labor, wages, safety, fairness) ■ **Consumer Protection**: – Passage of the Pure Food and Drug Act (1906) and the Meat Inspection Act (1906) to ensure the safety of food and drugs. – Advocacy for product labeling and truth in advertising.

Legislation - Civil Rights and Jim Crow Laws: Racial tensions persisted, particularly in the South, where the Jim Crow system of segregation and discrimination against African Americans was enforced. Debates over civil rights and equality for Black Americans laid the groundwork for the civil rights movement in the 20th century. ■ **Electoral Reforms**: Calls for electoral reforms, including the direct election of senators (prior to the 17th Amendment) and campaign finance reform, were part of the political discourse. These reforms aimed to make the political system more accountable and transparent. ■ **Foreign Policy**: The United States grappled with foreign policy issues, including imperialism and expansionism. Debates centered on whether the U.S. should pursue overseas territories and engage in international conflicts, such as the Spanish-American War. ■ **Immigration and Nativism**: The influx of immigrants from Europe and Asia led to debates about immigration policy and nativism. Nativist groups, such as the Know-Nothings, advocated for restrictions on immigration and expressed anti-immigrant sentiments.

Rural migration to cities - Massive Migration: Industrialization during the Gilded Age led to a massive influx of people from rural areas to urban centers. As industries boomed and job opportunities in factories and mills increased, individuals and families left their rural homes in search of better employment prospects in the cities.

Mass production - Industrialization led to the development of mass production techniques, notably pioneered by companies like Ford Motor Company. ■ **Mass production** allowed for the efficient and cost-effective manufacturing of goods on a large scale, making products more affordable to the average consumer.

West:

Nez Perce leader Chief Joseph - Chief Joseph (1840-1904) was a leader of the Wallowa band of the Nez Perce Tribe who became famous in 1877 for leading his people on an epic flight across the Rocky Mountains. He was born in 1840 and he was called Joseph by Reverend Henry H. Spalding (1803-1874), who had established a mission amongst the Nez Perce in 1836.

Dawes Act - takes native land, breaks it up into plots, and sells to settlers to develop/industrialize.

Politics - In 1803, President Thomas Jefferson purchased the territory of Louisiana from the French government for \$15 million. The Louisiana Purchase stretched from the Mississippi River to the Rocky Mountains and from Canada to New Orleans, and it doubled the size of the United States. To Jefferson, westward expansion was the key to the nation's health: He believed that a republic depended on an independent, virtuous

citizenry for its survival, and that independence and virtue went hand in hand with land ownership, especially the ownership of small farms. ("Those who labor on the earth," he wrote, "are the chosen people of God.").

Manifest Destiny - Manifest Destiny, a phrase coined in 1845, is the idea that the United States is destined—by God, its advocates believed—to expand its dominion and spread democracy and capitalism across the entire North American continent.

McKinley - William McKinley (January 29, 1843 – September 14, 1901) was an American politician who served as the 25th president of the United States from 1897 until his assassination in 1901. A member of the Republican Party, he led a realignment that made Republicans largely dominant in the industrial states and nationwide for decades.

Immigration:

19th century immigration - Irish Immigrants: The Irish were one of the largest immigrant groups during the Gilded Age. Many Irish immigrants arrived due to the Great Famine (Potato Famine) in Ireland in the mid-19th century. ■ They settled in cities like New York, Boston, and Chicago and played a significant role in labor, politics, and cultural life. ■ Scandinavian Immigrants: Immigrants from Scandinavian countries, such as Sweden, Norway, Denmark, and Finland, settled in the Midwest, particularly in states like Minnesota and Wisconsin. They contributed to the region's agricultural and cultural development. German Immigrants: German immigrants were among the most numerous and diverse groups. They brought with them a strong tradition of brewing, and their influence is still seen in American beer culture today. ■ Germans settled in various states, including Pennsylvania and the Midwest. Italian Immigrants: Italian immigrants, particularly from southern Italy, came to the U.S. seeking economic opportunities. They settled in urban areas like New York, Boston, and Chicago. Italian culture, cuisine, and traditions have had a lasting impact on American life. ■ Eastern European Jewish Immigrants: Jewish immigrants from Eastern Europe, including Russia and Poland, sought refuge from religious persecution and economic hardships. They settled in cities like New York and created vibrant Jewish communities. Polish Immigrants: Polish immigrants arrived in the U.S. in large numbers, settling in industrial cities like Chicago and Pittsburgh. They brought their traditions, including Polish cuisine and Catholicism, with them. ■ Greek Immigrants: Greek immigrants began arriving in the late 19th century, seeking economic opportunities and escaping political turmoil. They settled in urban areas and established Greek Orthodox churches and communities. ■ Austro-Hungarian Empire Immigrants: People from various ethnic backgrounds within the Austro-Hungarian Empire (which included parts of present-day Austria, Hungary, the Czech Republic, Slovakia, and more) immigrated to the U.S. Their diverse backgrounds enriched American culture. ■ Baltic Immigrants: Immigrants from the Baltic region, including Lithuania, Latvia, and Estonia, arrived in the U.S. in search of better economic prospects. They often settled in urban centers. ■ Armenian Immigrants: Armenians escaping persecution in the Ottoman Empire arrived in the U.S., particularly in the late 19th and early 20th centuries. They settled in cities like Boston and Los Angeles and made significant contributions to American society.

Progressivism 20th century:

Politics - The Progressive movement was a political and social-reform movement that brought major changes to the United States during the late 19th and early 20th centuries. During this time, known as the Progressive Era, the movement's goals involved

strengthening the national government and addressing people's economic, social, and political demands.

Goals - Progressives aimed to promote social justice, improve living and working conditions, expand democracy, and regulate big business. Key goals included protecting consumers, conserving natural resources, reforming the political system, and promoting social welfare.

Leaders - The national political leaders of the Progressive Era included Theodore Roosevelt, Robert M. La Follette Sr, Charles Evans Hughes, and Herbert Hoover on the Republican side, and William Jennings Bryan, Woodrow Wilson, and Al Smith on the Democratic side.

Reforms - Introduction of direct primary elections to give citizens greater influence in candidate selection. – Adoption of the Seventeenth Amendment (1913) for the direct election of U.S. senators. – Implementation of secret ballots to reduce electoral fraud.

Civil Rights and Racial Justice: ■ Founding of the National Association for the Advancement of Colored People (NAACP) in 1909 to fight for civil rights. ■ Advocacy for anti-lynching legislation and an end to racial segregation.

Women's Suffrage - take part in political movements, form labor unions, western states first to allow women to vote.

Labor Unions - The labor movement in the United States grew out of the need to protect the common interest of workers. For those in the industrial sector, organized labor unions fought for better wages, reasonable hours and safer working conditions. The labor movement led efforts to stop child labor, give health benefits and provide aid to workers who were injured or retired.

Knights of Labor 1869 - The Knights pressed for the eight-hour work day for laborers, and embraced a vision of a society in which workers, not capitalists, would own the industries in which they labored. The Knights also sought to end child labor and convict labor.

Labor leaders (ie. Gompers) - In 1881, he helped found the Federation of Organized Trades and Labor Unions which became the American Federation of Labor (A. F. of L. or AFL). He became its first president and served as such for most of the rest of his life (except the period when John McBride was president). Under his leadership, the union grew in size and influence. Gompers was witness to, and part of, many of the events that have become part of labor history including the Ludlow Massacre.

Journalists - A person who writes for newspapers, magazines, or news websites or prepares news to be broadcast.

(muckrakers) - Muckrakers were journalists and writers who exposed corruption, injustice, and social problems through their investigative reporting.

Immigration - There was a rapid increase in immigration between the late 19th century and early 20th century.

Trust Acts - Trust-busting refers to the breaking up of trusts, monopolies, and anti-competitive practices that dominated industries such as oil, railroads, and steel. The Sherman Antitrust Act of 1890 was the first major federal legislation aimed at preventing monopolistic practices and promoting competition.

Monopolies - Monopolies and Trusts: One of the most prominent debates centered on the rise of monopolies and trusts, such as Standard Oil and U.S. Steel.

US Imperialism:

Late 19th century imperialism - The late 19th century saw a significant expansion of American imperialism, driven by various factors. One major cause was economic interests. As the United States underwent industrialization, there was a growing need for raw materials and new markets to fuel economic growth. Additionally, American entrepreneurs sought to invest in foreign territories to take advantage of cheap labor and resources. Another important factor was the desire for strategic military bases and naval power. The development of steam-powered ships made it crucial for nations to have access to coaling stations and refueling points around the world. The acquisition of territories like Hawaii and the Philippines provided the United States with strategic locations for military operations in the Pacific.

Politics - From the beginning, the United States recognized the individual rights and liberties of the select few, demarcated by race, gender, and, crucially, property ownership. Indeed, “the rights of persons, and the rights of property,” James Madison asserted, “could not well be separated.” What did this inseparability mean to those who recognized communal relations rather than private property and to those who were violently shorn of their personhood to be made into property? As Roxanne Dunbar-Ortiz and many Indigenous studies scholars argue, the United States, as a settler colonial nation, is built on the dispossession and genocide of Indigenous peoples, whom the U.S. state and settlers sought to “destroy to replace” with their new and permanent society. It built this new society with the exploited labor of enslaved Black people, whose relegation to the status of property guaranteed their absolute subjugation. It has denied rights to a range of others by “deporting, hiding, or criminalizing them or otherwise revoking the right of the racialized outsiders to be within the invaded territory.”

Conflicts - Its war with the Spanish empire ultimately delivered Puerto Rico, Guam, and the Philippines to U.S. dominion, as well as the temporary occupation of Cuba and an effectively permanent foothold latched onto Guantánamo. Like those “domestic dependent nations,” these newly seized lands were destined neither for statehood nor full incorporation into the United States. The darker, “alien races” that populated these lands had not achieved the requisite levels of civilization or whiteness to be granted such a distinction. Instead, these foreign territories would be ruled by the United States as “unincorporated territories” where the Constitution does not fully apply. As is well known, Puerto Ricans have formal U.S. citizenship but no right to vote for the U.S. president from home and no congressional members to represent the island's interests.

Territories - U.S. imperialism took a variety of forms in the early 20th century, ranging from colonies in Puerto Rico and the Philippines to protectorates in Cuba, Panama, and other countries in Latin America, and open door policies such as that in China. Formal colonies would be ruled with U.S.-appointed colonial governors and supported by U.S. troops.

Monroe Doctrine - The Monroe Doctrine, first outlined in a speech to Congress in 1823, had President James Monroe warning European powers to not attempt further colonization, military intervention or other interference in the Western Hemisphere, stating that the United States would view any such interference as a potentially hostile act.

Open Door Policy - Issued by U.S. secretary of state John Hay (1899), the statement reaffirmed the principle that all countries should have equal access to any Chinese port open to trade. The U.S. sent notes to Britain, Germany, France, Italy, Japan, and Russia

explaining the policy to prevent them from establishing separate spheres of influence in China.

Roosevelt Corollary - Roosevelt Corollary, foreign policy declaration by U.S. Pres. Theodore Roosevelt in 1904–05 stating that, in cases of flagrant and chronic wrongdoing by a Latin American country, the United States would intervene in that country's internal affairs.

Dollar Diplomacy - Dollar Diplomacy, foreign policy created by U.S. Pres. William Howard Taft (served 1909–13) and his secretary of state, Philander C. Knox, to ensure the financial stability of a region while protecting and extending U.S. commercial and financial interests there.

Treaty of Paris - Treaty of Paris, (1898), treaty concluding the Spanish-American War. It was signed by representatives of Spain and the United States in Paris on Dec. 10, 1898. Armistice negotiations conducted in Washington, D.C., ended with the signing of a protocol on Aug. 12, 1898, which, besides ending hostilities, provided that a peace conference be held in Paris by October, that Spain relinquish Cuba and cede Puerto Rico and one of the Mariana Islands to the United States, and that the United States hold Manila until the disposition of the Philippines had been determined.

Roosevelt - (born October 27, 1858, New York, New York, U.S.—died January 6, 1919, Oyster Bay, New York) 26th president of the United States (1901–09) and a writer, naturalist, and soldier. He expanded the powers of the presidency and of the federal government in support of the public interest in conflicts between big business and labor and steered the nation toward an active role in world politics, particularly in Europe and Asia.

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Panama Canal - The Panama Canal was first developed following the failure of a French construction team in the 1880s, when the United States commenced building a canal across a 50-mile stretch of the narrow Panama isthmus in 1904. The project was helped by the elimination of disease-carrying mosquitoes, while chief engineer John Stevens devised innovative techniques and spurred the redesign from a sea-level to a lock canal. His successor, Lt. Col. George Washington Goethals, stepped up excavation efforts of a stubborn mountain range and oversaw the building of the dams and locks.

WWI:

Cause - The immediate cause of World War I that made the aforementioned items come into play (alliances, imperialism, militarism, nationalism) was the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand of Austria-Hungary.

US Entry - After the rupture of diplomatic relations with Germany on February 3, 1917, events pushed the United States inexorably along the road to war. Using his authority as commander in chief, Wilson on March 9 ordered the arming of American merchant ships so that they could defend themselves against U-boat attacks. German submarines sank three U.S. merchant ships during March 16–18 with heavy loss of life. Supported by his Cabinet, by most newspapers, and by a large segment of public opinion, Wilson made the decision on March 20 for the United States to declare war on Germany, and on March 21 he called Congress to meet in special session on April 2.

Woodrow Wilson - Woodrow Wilson (1856-1924), the 28th U.S. president, served in office from 1913 to 1921 and led America through World War I (1914-1918).

Remembered as an advocate for democracy, progressivism and world peace, Wilson left a complex legacy that included re-segregating many branches of the federal workforce.

Treaty of Versailles - The Treaty of Versailles, signed in 1919 at the Palace of Versailles in Paris at the end of World War I, codified peace terms between Germany and the victorious Allies. The Treaty of Versailles held Germany responsible for starting the war and imposed harsh penalties on the Germans, including loss of territory, massive reparations payments and demilitarization.

League of Nations - The League of Nations was an international diplomatic group developed after World War I as a way to solve disputes between countries before they erupted into open warfare. A precursor to the United Nations, the League achieved some victories but had a mixed record of success, sometimes putting self-interest before becoming involved with conflict resolution, while also contending with governments that did not recognize its authority. The League effectively ceased operations during World War II.

Impacts - WW1 caused the downfall of four monarchies: Germany, Turkey, Austria-Hungary, and Russia. The war made people more open to other ideologies, such as the Bolsheviks that came to power in Russia and fascism that triumphed in Italy and even later in Germany. WW1 largely marked the end of colonialism, as the people became more nationalistic and one country after the other started colonial revolts in Southeast Asia, the Middle East, and Africa. The war changed the economical balance of the world, leaving European countries deep in debt and making the U.S. the leading industrial power and creditor in the world. Inflation shot up in most countries and the German economy was highly affected by having to pay for reparations. With troops traveling all over the world, influenza spread easily and an epidemic started which killed more than 25 million people across the world. With all the new weapons that were used, WW1 changed the face of modern warfare forever. Due to the cruel methods used during the war and the losses suffered, WW1 caused a lot of bitterness among nations, which also greatly contributed to WW2 decades later. Social life also changed: women had to run businesses while the men were at war and labor laws started to be enforced due to mass production and mechanization. People all wanted better living standards. After WW1, the need for an international body of nations that promotes security and peace worldwide became evident. This caused the founding of the League of Nations. WW1 boosted research in technology because better transport and means of communication gave countries an advantage over their enemies. The harsh conditions of the Treaty of Versailles caused a lot of dissent in Europe, especially on the side of the Central Powers who had to pay a lot for financial reparations.

Red Scare in the United States after World War I - The Red Scare was a period of heightened fear of radicalism in the United States after World War I. Labor unrest, the growth of bolshevism internationally, and a series of bombings triggered a number of government raids on suspected radicals, often in violation of civil liberties.

Espionage Act - Enforced largely by A. Mitchell Palmer, the United States attorney general under President Woodrow Wilson, the Espionage Act essentially made it a crime for any person to convey information intended to interfere with the U.S. armed forces prosecution of the war effort or to promote the success of the country's enemies. Anyone

found guilty of such acts would be subject to a fine of \$10,000 and a prison sentence of 20 years.

Sedition Acts - The Alien and Sedition Acts were a series of four laws passed by the U.S. Congress in 1798 during the administration of President John Adams amid widespread fear that a foreign war against France was imminent. The laws—which remain controversial to this day—restricted the activities of foreign residents in the country and limited freedom of speech and of the press, particularly when it was critical of the president or the government. Most, but not all, of the laws have expired or been repealed over the years.